decided to scrap 500 and 1,000 rupee notes. Even if I go to work, getting wages is again uncertain because the contractors also are short of 100 rupee notes to pay the wages,' says Basanti while waiting for someone who can hire her for a day's work. At least 3,000 labourers gathered at Bhubaneswar's Nayapali labour point are passing through similar uncertain fate. As migrants from almost all parts of rural Odisha struggle for survival, the state of these labourers is symptomatic of the situation of poor people across the state.[10]

Tribal Communities

As per the 2011 Census, India has a population of 104 million tribals, constituting 8.6 per cent of the total population, who live mostly in and around forest areas. As many earn a living by selling minor forest products like honey, berries and herbs, they struggle to make ends meet, even at the best of times.

Already at a disadvantage due to lower income and education levels and poorer access to banking and health services than the rest of the population,[11] tribal communities across the country were hurt badly by demonetization. Demand for their products dropped overnight and they were unable to get cash for the limited produce that they could sell.

- 'More than a currency crisis, the situation is becoming a humanitarian crisis. The tribal families who come here after painstakingly collecting the minor forest produce by spending up to four to five days in the jungles are forced to return empty handed as we have no money to procure it. It is really a very sad situation,' said Rajitha K.A., an official at the Scheduled Tribes Cooperative Society at Kallur near Sultan Bathery. 'But now the business is down to a bare minimum due to the weekly currency withdrawal limit of ₹24,000 applicable to the society. We are